PHOTOGRAPHY / SPENCER GRAY

NO FIXED PATH



PLANTS. NOISE. OPEN AIR.

A PHOTOGRAPHIC FIELD JOURNAL / V2

A life in the looking.

04 ROOTED

16 PERMISSION

20 ELECTRIC

30 OPEN AIR

38 MAKE SOMETHING REAL

Cannabis, concerts and the natural world.

A route through the work, and the confidence

to follow a creative path.

There is another way.

The work collected here follows Spencer Gray through cannabis photography, live music and the outdoors. His professional path crosses retail, brand strategy, visual storytelling and print production: different ways of working with a thing that needs to be seen.

There is a personal hinge behind that range. Spencer describes LSD as helping him believe in himself, loosen expectations around what he was supposed to do, and find the nerve to follow a creative life. This book takes that confidence as its starting point.

Plants, noise, open air. A route made by looking.



Begin with a living thing.



A closer kind of looking.

Cannabis brings an extraordinary amount of detail into a small space. Resin, veins, curled leaves and the shape of a flower ask for patient attention.

For Ideal Cannabis, Clear Creek Cannabis and Doghouse, Spencer's archive moves between product portraits and living plants. Structure, surface and color carry the frame.

THE SUBJECT IS SMALL.
THE WORLD INSIDE IT IS NOT.


GRAPE DIAMONDS / IDEAL CANNABIS
IDEAL CANNABIS
OREGON



GELATO SUNDAY / LIVING FLOWER



RAPPER KUSH / FLOWER PORTRAIT



APPLES AND BANANAS / DOGHOUSE



A FLOWER BECOMES A LANDSCAPE.



FROSTED CHERRY COOKIES



KUSH MINTS



CANDIED LEMONS



PHANTOM CAKE



GUARD DOG



JOHNNY GLAZE



GRAPE FRUIT SLUSHIE



CAKE DOG



LAYER CAKE / THE SURFACE OPENS

CLOSER STILL



GORILLA BUTTER / WHITE TRUFFLE CUT

Permission to begin.

A creative life begins to feel possible when someone else's expectations stop being its only measure.

“It enabled me to believe in myself and escape the idea of what I was supposed to do and gave me fuel to pursue a creative path without fear.”

SAME LIGHT.



DIFFERENT ROOM.



A room in motion.



LIVE MUSIC / FROM THE PHOTOGRAPHIC ARCHIVE

A frame holds an instant.

The room keeps moving.





The nerve of a voice.

Dijon is a major influence in Spencer's creative life. In these frames, the performance moves between concentration and release.

Then let it out.



DIJON / LIVE ARCHIVE / FEBRUARY 2020



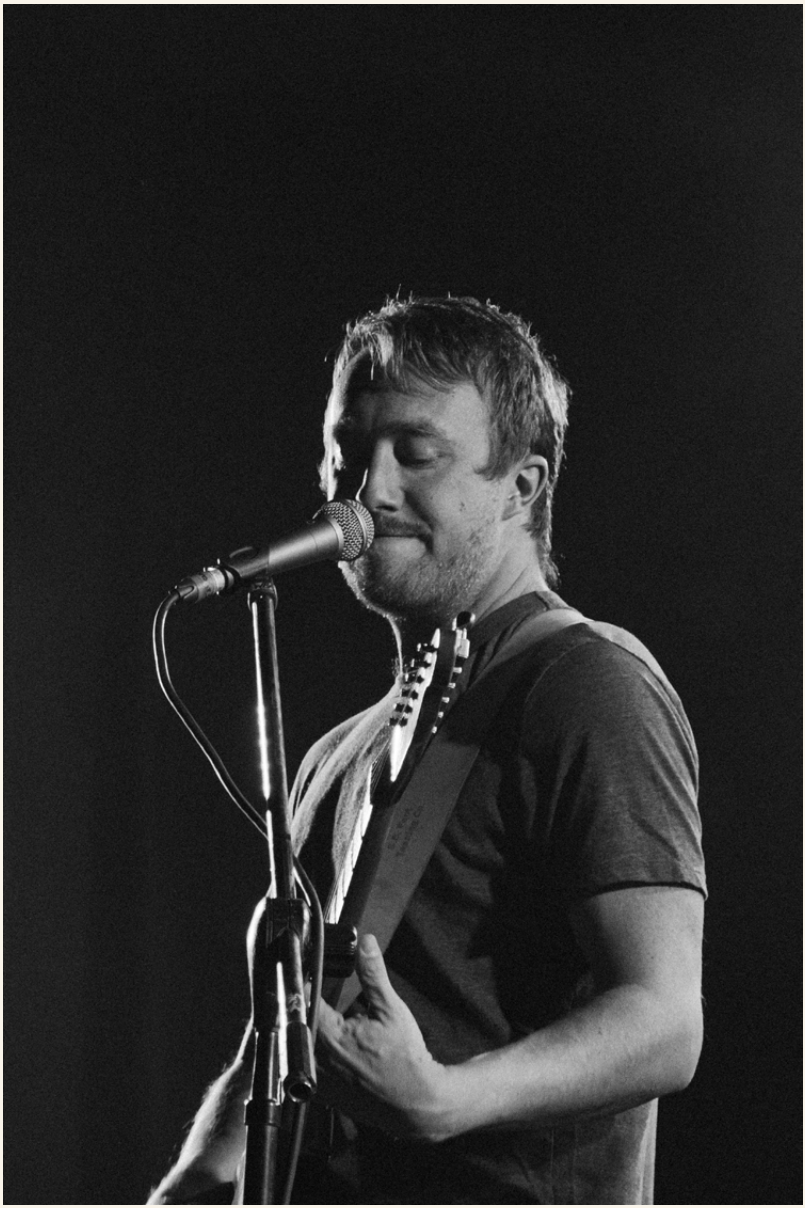




A QUIETER MOMENT INSIDE THE NOISE.



ALL ALLAN HOUR TOUR / JUNE 2024



You cannot hold the whole song.



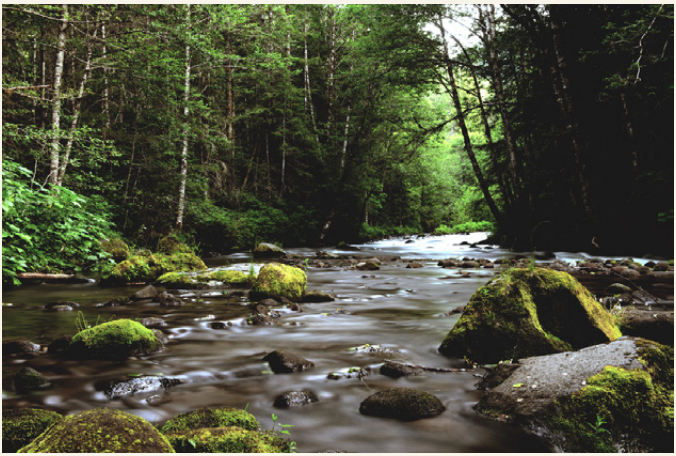
Live photography asks for a different kind of attention: to movement, light and the person inside the performance. In Spencer's archive, music sits beside cannabis as another place where looking closely becomes a way to participate.



A way back outside.

A canopy breaks the sky into pieces. Water finds a route through stone. A fern repeats a pattern already present in the flower.

The landscapes in this archive offer another pace. Between the mountain, the river and the trees, the eye has room to wander. The cultivated plant belongs to a much larger living world.



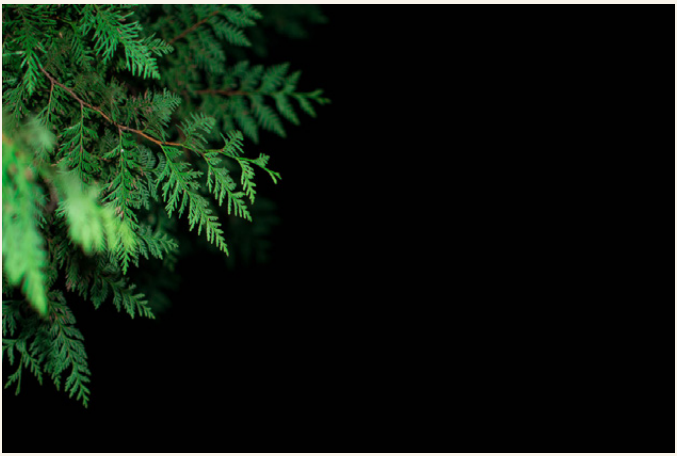
01 / WATER FINDS ITS WAY



02 / THE PATTERN REPEATS

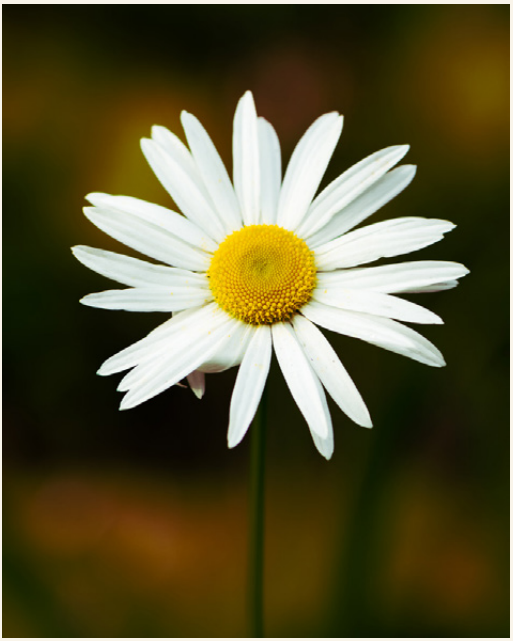


03 / THE DISTANT SHAPE



04 / THE NEARBY SHAPE



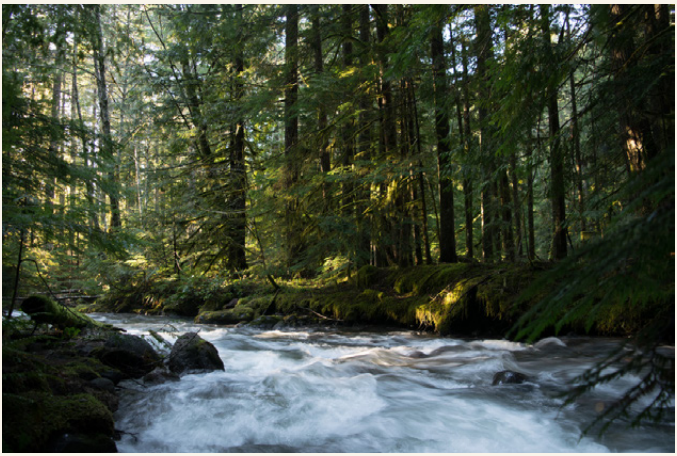


Room for something ordinary.

MT HOOD ARCHIVE / DAISY



A path can exist
without telling you
who to become.



Stay long enough
for another detail
to appear.

An idea needs a form.

The creative path does not end when the shutter closes. Spencer's work extends into brand design, websites and print production: photographs become parts of larger systems, and ideas become objects people can use.

A zine belongs to that same process. The image leaves the screen, takes on scale and paper, and becomes something that can pass from one set of hands to another.







01 / SUNGROWN



02 / SUNGROWN



03 / SUNGROWN



04 / SUNGROWN



05 / SUNGROWN



06 / SUNGROWN



WHITE TRUFFLE / LEAF STRUCTURE



APPLES AND BANANAS / FLOWER STRUCTURE

The next frame is open.

No fixed path does not mean no direction. In this selection, direction comes from the willingness to look closely, follow curiosity, and make something from what is found.

A flower, a performer, a bend in a trail: each asks for a different response. Together, they sketch a practice that has room to change.

KEEP FOLLOWING THE LIGHT



The work, collected.

01 Sungrown / dusk
04-05 Outdoor garden
07 Grape Diamonds
08 Gelato Sunday
09 Rapper Kush
10-11 Apples and Bananas
12 Frosted Cherry Cookies; Kush Mints; Candied Lemons; Phantom Cake
13 Guard Dog; Johnny Glaze; Grape Fruit Slushie; Cake Dog
14 Layer Cake / detail
15 White Truffle Cut
18 Apples and Bananas / color
19-29 Live music archive
30 Trillium Lake hike
32-33 Mt Hood / four studies
34 Sungrown / leaf
35 Mt Hood / daisy
36-37 Mt Hood / road + river
39 Blue Magoo
40 Mike Larry
41 Sungrown / six studies
42 White Truffle / leaf
43 Apples and Bananas / detail
45 Sungrown / evening
48 Sungrown / leaf

Photographs: Spencer Gray.
Personal account: Spencer Gray, from his own words.
Editorial and design assistance: Codex.

Drawn from personal and client photography archives. Cultivar names follow source files. Dijon, Allan Rayman and Wilderado are identified; other performers remain unnamed where not established.

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KEEP YOUR EYES OPEN.

behance.net/spencergray47


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SPENCER GRAY
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